

Process & Decision Documentation

Project/Assignment Decisions

For this side quest, I focused on adding a simple debug system to my existing game without changing the core structure. I designed it so that pressing F opens a debug mode, where players can toggle features using keys. Pressing 1 enables moon gravity, and pressing 2 increases movement speed. I also wanted the debug mode to feel more immersive and noticeable, so I added a darker screen overlay, a different music track ("metal.mp3"), and a wolf meme that appears in the corner. This creates the "alpha mode" effect when debug is active, making it feel like a crazy state rather than just a basic settings menu. Most of my decisions were about keeping the system simple but visually engaging, while still building on top of the existing code instead of restructuring everything.

Side Quest: *GenAI Documentation*

Date Used: 20 Feb 2026

Tool Disclosure: ChatGPT (GPT 5.2)

Purpose of Use: I used ChatGPT to help me add a debug screen to the provided game, including toggleable features like moon gravity and fast movement. I also used it to help implement extra features like a dark overlay, sound effects, and displaying an image on screen.

Summary of Interaction: I shared my existing code and asked ChatGPT how to add a debug system without restructuring everything. It gave step-by-step instructions on adding variables, key inputs, and UI elements. I also asked follow-up questions when things didn't work, like file paths and blurry text, and adjusted the code based on that.

Human Decision Point(s): I chose how the debug system should behave (ex, using the "F" key to open it, and deciding when the music and wolf meme should appear). I also adjusted values like gravity, speed, and layout to fit the game. When the debug text looked blurry, I manually changed the font size and spacing instead of relying fully on the AI suggestion.

Integrity & Verification Note: All code provided by ChatGPT was reviewed and tested by me. I made changes when things didn't work properly (such as fixing file paths and adjusting the UI appearance). I ensured everything ran correctly in my own project before finalizing it.

Scope of GenAI Use: ChatGPT was used for the debug feature implementation (toggles, key inputs), adding sound and image display, troubleshooting issues (blurry text, file paths), and general coding guidance. All final decisions and adjustments were made by me.

Limitations or Misfires: One issue was that the debug text appeared blurry due to the small canvas size and scaling. The AI suggested fixes, but they didn't fully solve the problem, so I manually adjusted font size and spacing. There was also confusion around file paths since my assets were not all in the same folder, which required debugging on my end.

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)

I started with the provided working game and used ChatGPT to guide the addition of a debug system. I implemented features step-by-step, testing as I went. When issues came up (like blurry text or incorrect file paths), I problem-solved by adjusting the code myself. The final result is a working debug screen with custom features that I refined beyond the AI's initial suggestions.

Decision Points & Trade-offs

Decision 1: When the wolf meme and music should appear

- Options considered: Trigger on key "1" (Moon Gravity) and trigger when the debug menu opens (F key)
- Why: I chose to connect it to the debug menu (F key) because it felt more cohesive and easier to control as a single "debug mode" experience.

Verification & Judgement

I tested each feature individually (movement, gravity toggle, sound, image display) to make sure they worked correctly. I also verified that the correct files were loading by fixing file paths and ensuring the names matched exactly. Final adjustments were made based on how the game felt and looked, not just whether the code worked.

Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions

The debug text initially appeared blurry due to scaling, which required manual fixes. The file path issues caused the assets not to load at first as well. There also may still be better ways to structure UI elements (ex, a nicer in-game debug panel).

Appendix

ChatGPT Chat: <https://chatgpt.com/share/69bdb0a8-25c4-8003-b763-7a2b1ad56e0d>

References of the images used in this Side Quest

nickpanekAlassets. Aggressive Nu-Thrash Metal Instrumental – Socrates Mode.

Pixabay,

<https://pixabay.com/music/metal-aggressive-nu-thrash-metal-instrumental-socrates-mode-472080/>

wolf.jpg (used on debug screen). Source: Pinterest (original creator not identified),

<https://ca.pinterest.com/pin/16395986140152830/>